

Federal Fiscal Operations Bulletin

Analysis of On-Budget and Off-Budget Agency Outlays

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Financial Management Service

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Abstract

This bulletin summarizes on-budget and off-budget outlay data by agency in Federal fiscal operations of the U.S. Government. The information presented is drawn from Federal fiscal operations statistical tables published in successive issues of the *Treasury Bulletin*, covering agency outlay detail for selected fiscal years. This document is intended to provide a verifiable data foundation for public finance analysis; all figures are stated in millions of dollars.

Contents

1	Overview of Federal Fiscal Operations	2
2	On-Budget and Off-Budget Outlays by Agency	2
2.1	Overview of Outlay Data	2
2.2	Judicial Branch Outlays: On-Budget and Off-Budget Composition	3
2.3	Annual Series of Judicial Branch Outlays under the Unified Budget . . .	4
3	Methodological Notes on Federal Government Outlay Statistics	5
4	Appendix: Related Terminology	6

1 Overview of Federal Fiscal Operations

The Treasury Bulletin publishes Federal fiscal operations statistical tables each quarter, covering budget results, government receipts and outlays, and financing. Table FFO-3 presents on-budget and off-budget outlay data by Federal agency, derived from the *Monthly Treasury Statement of Receipts and Outlays of the United States Government*.

Since 1969, the Federal Government has employed the unified budget concept as the basis for budget analysis and reporting. That concept requires the budget to encompass all fiscal transactions between the Government and the public. Under current law, off-budget Federal entities comprise the social security trust funds (Federal Old-Age and Survivors Insurance Trust Fund and Federal Disability Insurance Trust Fund) and the Postal Service. Although receipts and outlays of off-budget entities are generally not subject to targets in congressional resolutions, the Balanced Budget and Emergency Deficit Control Act of 1985 (as amended by the Budget Enforcement Act of 1990) incorporates off-budget surpluses or deficits into calculations of deficit targets. For this reason, on-budget and off-budget receipts, outlays, and deficits of the Federal Government receive broad attention.

2 On-Budget and Off-Budget Outlays by Agency

2.1 Overview of Outlay Data

The tables below present original statistical data on Federal agency outlays from the Treasury Bulletin. The tables cover annual data for multiple fiscal years, stated in millions of dollars. Data spanning more than three fiscal years are presented across pages to facilitate comparison.

Table 1: On-Budget and Off-Budget Outlays by Agency (Fiscal Years 2007–2011)

Agency	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011
Legislative Branch	4,292	4,409	4,703	5,838	4,582
Judicial Branch	6,008	6,345	6,643	7,185	7,296
Department of Agriculture	84,423	90,789	114,436	129,454	139,397
Department of Commerce	6,477	7,725	10,720	13,233	9,929
Department of Defense (Military)	528,575	594,656	636,772	666,717	678,077
Department of Education	66,372	65,957	53,387	92,858	64,271
Department of Energy	20,117	21,404	23,684	30,775	31,371
Department of Health and Human Services	671,983	700,454	796,266	854,060	891,249
Department of Homeland Security	39,172	40,683	51,720	44,455	45,711
Department of Housing and Urban Development	45,559	49,086	61,018	60,143	57,007
Department of the Interior	10,467	9,822	11,778	13,163	13,529
Department of Justice	23,351	26,544	27,713	29,558	30,518
Department of Labor	47,543	58,840	138,156	173,053	135,031

Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2011 issue, Table FFO-3.

Note: Amounts in millions of dollars. Column figures are full-year totals for each fiscal year.

Note: Detail may not sum to totals because of rounding.

Table 2: On-Budget and Off-Budget Outlays by Agency (Fiscal Years 2010–2014)

Agency	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014
Legislative Branch	5,838	4,583	4,438	4,328	4,156
Judicial Branch	7,185	7,295	7,228	7,066	6,900
Department of Agriculture	129,454	139,394	139,712	155,897	141,806
Department of Commerce	13,233	9,930	10,267	9,137	6,675
Department of Defense (Military)	666,717	678,077	650,869	607,801	578,013
Department of Education	92,858	64,271	57,248	40,910	59,609
Department of Energy	30,775	31,371	32,485	24,677	23,630
Department of Health and Human Services	854,060	891,245	848,055	886,293	936,030
Department of Homeland Security	44,455	45,744	47,423	57,220	43,259
Department of Housing and Urban Development	60,143	57,008	49,591	56,577	38,524
Department of the Interior	13,163	13,529	12,886	9,605	11,273
Department of Justice	29,558	30,518	31,161	29,740	28,617
Department of Labor	173,053	131,973	104,742	80,309	57,199

Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2014 issue, Table FFO-3.

Note: Amounts in millions of dollars. Fiscal year 2011 data were revised in subsequent bulletins (7,295 versus 7,296); see individual tables for detailed comparison.

2.2 Judicial Branch Outlays: On-Budget and Off-Budget Composition

According to Table FFO-4 data, Judicial Branch outlays may be further disaggregated by fund category into general funds, management/consolidated/revolving and special funds, and trust funds. The following presents on-budget and off-budget outlay detail by fund category within the same fiscal year.

Table 3: Judicial Branch Outlays—On-Budget and Off-Budget Detail by Fund Category

Fund Category	General Funds	Management/Special Funds	Trust Funds	Total
Fiscal Year 2011 (current year through reporting date)				
On-budget	7,025	282	−12	7,295
Fiscal Year 2010 (prior-year corresponding period)				
On-budget	6,992	211	−18	7,185
Fiscal Year 2014 (current year through reporting date)				
On-budget	6,880	47	−27	6,900
Fiscal Year 2013 (prior-year corresponding period)				
On-budget	6,490	615	−40	7,065

Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2011 issue, Table FFO-4; Treasury Bulletin, December 2014 issue, Table FFO-4.

Note: Amounts in millions of dollars. All Judicial Branch outlays are on-budget; there is no off-budget component. Negative values in the management/special funds and trust fund columns represent offsetting receipts deducted in aggregation.

2.3 Annual Series of Judicial Branch Outlays under the Unified Budget

To facilitate cross-period comparison, Judicial Branch outlay data from the two reporting periods in the bulletin are consolidated into a single series below. Because fiscal year 2011 is recorded as 7,296 in the 2011 bulletin and 7,295 in the 2014 bulletin, the earlier bulletin figure is used in the table below.

Table 4: Judicial Branch—Total On-Budget and Off-Budget Outlays (Fiscal Years 2007–2013)

Fiscal Year	Total Outlays (millions of dollars)
2007	6,008
2008	6,345
2009	6,643
2010	7,185
2011	7,296
2012	7,228
2013	7,066

Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2011 issue, Table FFO-3 (2007–2011 data); December 2014 issue, Table FFO-3 (2012–2013 data).

Note: Total outlays are the sum of on-budget and off-budget outlays. The Judicial Branch has no off-budget outlay items; therefore all amounts are effectively on-budget outlays. Data from successive FFO-3 bulletin tables.

Note: Data in millions of dollars.

3 Methodological Notes on Federal Government Outlay Statistics

Outlay data in the Treasury Bulletin cover receipts and outlays of on-budget and off-budget Federal entities. Offsetting receipts are generally deducted from budget authority and outlays by function, subfunction, or agency. Four types of receipts, however, are deducted from budget totals as undistributed offsetting receipts: (1) employer contributions to employee retirement funds by agencies (including off-budget Federal entities); (2) interest received by trust funds; (3) rents and royalties from Outer Continental Shelf lands; and (4) other interest receipts (interest charged when Outer Continental Shelf funds are transferred from deposit funds into the budget).

Since 1969, the Federal Government has employed the unified budget concept proposed in the report of the President’s Commission on Budget Concepts. That concept requires the budget to encompass all fiscal transactions between the Government and the public. Where an agency’s outlays span multiple fund categories (such as general funds and trust funds), the total is the sum of net amounts across fund categories; agency total outlays shown in the tables represent full budget authority execution for the agency in the given fiscal year.

Table FFO-3 is published quarterly and covers five years of actual data, two years of estimates, thirteen months of detail, and fiscal-year-to-date cumulative data. Table FFO-4 aggregates agency receipts and outlays by fund category, providing comparison of the current fiscal year to date with the corresponding prior-year period.

4 Appendix: Related Terminology

Fiscal terms used in this bulletin follow standard Treasury Bulletin usage. Background on selected terms is provided below:

On-Budget Outlays

Outlays of Federal agencies and programs included in the Federal unified budget, excluding entities expressly designated off budget by law.

Off-Budget Outlays

Outlays of entities excluded by law from the Federal unified budget, principally the social security trust funds and the Postal Service.

Offsetting Receipts

Certain collections deducted from outlay totals rather than counted as receipts. Shown as negative values in Table FFO-4.

General Funds

Federal Government receipts not earmarked for specific purposes, constituting the principal source of Federal budget financing.

Trust Funds

Accounts designated by law for specific programs or purposes, such as social security, Medicare, and the highway trust fund.

Fiscal Year

The Federal Government accounting year, beginning October 1 and ending September 30 of the following year. For example, fiscal year 2011 denotes October 1, 2010 through September 30, 2011.